WARNING When designing a policy, be sure to consider the effect of your policy. In some circumstances it may be better to fail quickly instead of retrying a request that is never going to succeed. Polly includes additional policies such as circuit-breakers to create more advanced approaches.

The Polly error handler is an example of an optional `HttpMessageHandler` that you can plug in to your `HttpClient`, but you can also create your own custom handler. In the next section you'll see how to create a handler that adds a header to all outgoing requests.

33.4 Creating a custom HttpMessageHandler

Most third-party APIs require some form of authentication when you're calling them. For example, many services require you to attach an API key to an outgoing request, so that the request can be tied to your account. Instead of having to remember to add this header manually for every request to the API, you could configure a custom `HttpMessageHandler` to attach the header automatically for you.

NOTE More complex APIs may use JSON Web Tokens (JWT) obtained from an identity provider. If that's the case, consider using the open source IdentityModel library (https://identitymodel.readthedocs.io), which provides integration points for ASP.NET Core Identity and `HttpClientFactory`.

You can configure a named or typed client using `IHttpClientFactory` to use your API-key handler as part of the `HttpClient`'s handler pipeline, as shown in figure 33.6. When you use